With a view to ensuring early completion of projects for providing irrigation benefits to the farmers, ***Rural Infrastructure Development Fund*** (RIDF) has been in operation since 1995–96. The Government launched ***Accelerated Irrigation Benefits Programme*** (AIBP) in 1996–97.

The Accelerated Irrigation Benefit Programme (AIBP) was launched during 1996–97 to give loan assistance to the States to help them complete some of the incomplete major/medium irrigation projects which were in an advanced stage of completion.

NATIONAL FOOD SECURITY MISSION (NFSM)

The NFSM, launched in 2007, is a **crop development** scheme of the Government of India that aims at additional production of 10, 8, and 2 million tonnes of rice, wheat, and pulses, respectively by the end of 2011-12. The Mission interventions consist of[39]:

(a) seeds of improved variety
(b) soil ameliorants
(c) plant nutrients
(d) farm machines/implements, and
(e) plant protection measures

In addition, a special initiative under the name of the *Accelerated Pulses Production Programme* was initiated in 2010 to boost the production of pulses by active promotion of technologies in 1,000 clusters of 1,000 ha (hectare) each.

Considerable achievements under the NFSM have been recorded during the course of implementation of the programme such as new farm practices, distribution of seeds of high yielding varieties of rice, wheat, pulses, and hybrid rice, and treating area with soil ameliorants to restore soil fertility for higher productivity. Through targeted interventions, the mission has already achieved, a year in advance, 25 millions tonnes of additional production of foodgrains exceeding the target of 20 million tonnes of production set for the terminal year 2011-12, of the 11th Plan.